meeting at Sharm-el-Sheikh promising India's peaceful cooperation with Pakistan, however, the entire BJP-led opposition angrily stormed out of Parliament, accusing Prime Minister Singh of "betraying" his promise that "there would be no talks with Pakistan" until the latter fully admitted its role in launching terrorist attacks against India and had properly "punished" those terrorists.[16]

Many angry and frustrated extremists in both nations will, doubtless, try to derail the peace process. It might require years, if not decades, of patience and persistent fortitude before India and Pakistan finally attain sanity and prosperity together. But the younger generations of both nations will surely prevail, should their elders lose heart and seek to fall back upon ancient religious hatreds or narrow national antipathies.

The music of peace played by Salman Ahmad's great rock band Junoon is as popular today among the youth of India as in its birthplace in Pakistan. Mira Nair's brilliant films bring joy and tears to the hearts and eyes of as many young Pakistani devotees as they do to their millions of ardent fans throughout India. And Arundhati Roy's novel *The God of Small Things* has inspired readers throughout the world, as have her subsequent courageous essays defying electrified fences and high concrete walls erected to divide people, but incapable of screening out joyous songs of love and freedom, and our universal longing for peace.